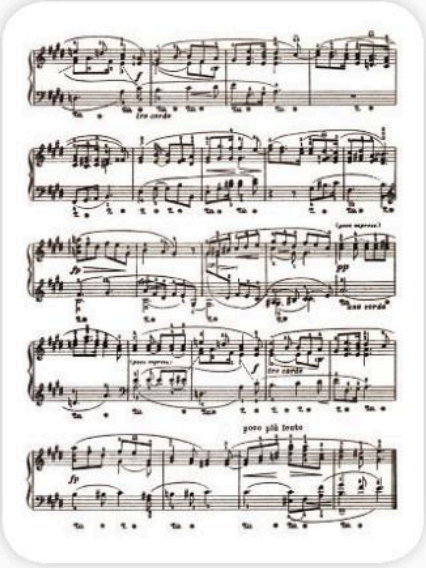2.5 Use content responsibly

In this lesson

You will learn:

- what intellectual property is
- how to use internet content responsibly and legally.

In this unit you have learned about the dangers posed by criminals on the internet. Theft of money and identity theft are serious problems on the internet. Another problem is the theft of intellectual property.

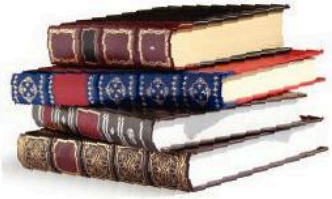


Intellectual property

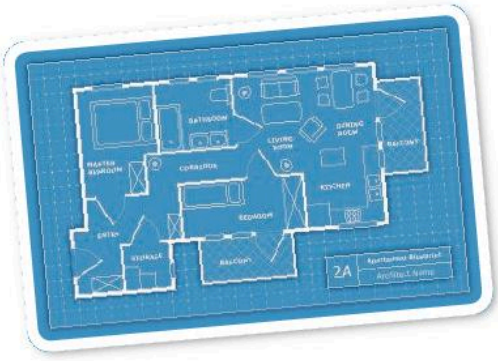
Intellectual property means something that you have created using your mind (your intellect) and that you own.

Intellectual property can be:

- written work – books, poems, articles and web pages
- images and artwork – cartoons, paintings, photos and sculptures
- music and songs
- plans and designs
- computer software and games.









Intellectual property rights protect the creator of a piece of work. It is illegal for another person to steal or misuse the work. You can only use another person's work if they give you permission.



Copyright, trademarks and patents

There are different types of intellectual property. Each has its own symbol.

Type of intellectual property	Symbol	Description
Copyright	©	**Copyright** means you have the right to copy your work. Other people must ask your permission before they can use it. You automatically have copyright for any work you create.
Trade mark	TM	Companies use trademarks to protect logos, slogans and product names. The Microsoft logo is a trademark.
Patent	℗	Inventors use patents to protect their new inventions. A patent stops other people from copying an invention and claiming it as their own idea.
Registered design	®	This is used to protect designs like wallpaper and carpet patterns.

Explore more

Every week, you use equipment and books at home and school. You use websites. You buy food and other items from shops. This week, look carefully at all the items you use and buy. Can you find an example of each of the four types of intellectual property described in the table?

What copyright means to you

You can legally use someone else's work in these situations:

- You have purchased their work. It may be an application program, game or music track. The work comes with a licence that allows you to use it. The licence will tell you exactly what you can and cannot do with the work.
- The owner of the work has given you permission to use their work. The owner will say what you can and cannot do with the content. For example, you may have permission to use a photo in your own work but not to change it.

Software piracy

Copyright theft is a type of cybercrime. Criminals make copies of music, games and films. They sell the copies, often over the internet. This type of crime is called piracy. When software is illegally copied and sold, it is called software piracy. When legal copies of software, music and games are sold, the person who created the work gets some money from each sale. When pirated copies are sold, the person does not get any money.

It is illegal to download and use pirated versions of software and other files.

Activity

Work with a partner or in a small group. Make a list of all the reasons why it might be a bad idea to download software from unofficial web pages.

Finding images on the internet

Many software apps provide images you can use – for example, web-editing tools like Wix and presentation software like Microsoft PowerPoint. You can also use many of the images that you find on the web.

Creative Commons

Many content owners make their images available free of charge on the internet. They use a special licence called **Creative Commons**. Creative Commons lets you use images without having to ask the owner for permission. Creative Commons music and video content is also available.

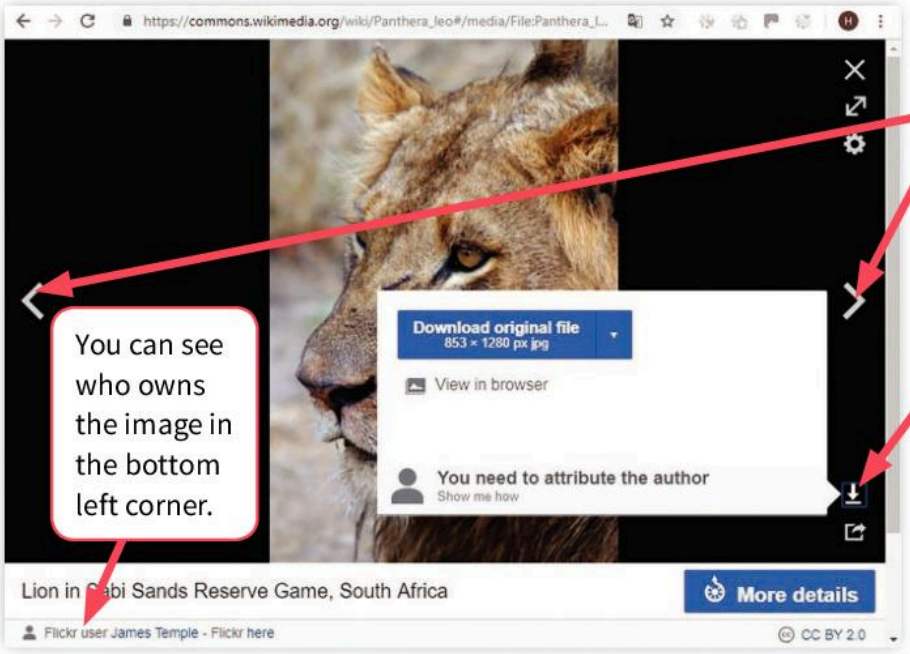
How to find Creative Commons images

There are websites that allow you to search for Creative Commons images. The one used in this example is called Wikimedia Commons. Other sites include Pixabay and Unsplash.

Enter key words for the images you are looking for in the search box. In this example the search is for 'Lions'. Your search will provide you with a list of images that match your key words. Sometimes you will see a page with information about the subject you have searched for. Scroll down the page to find the selection of images. Sometimes you will just see a list of links.

Clicking on an image opens a picture browser. The browser shows the image you have selected. There is information about the image below it.





You can see who owns the image in the bottom left corner.

The arrows at the left and right of the page let you move between images without returning to the search list.

Click on the download button. The download box reminds you that you must attribute (credit) the author.

Giving credit for the images you use

The owner of a Creative Commons image gives you permission to use the image. Most owners ask you to give credit for the work. A credit includes the owner's name and a link to the website you got the image from.

Below the message 'You need to attribute the author' is a link that says 'Show me how'. If you click the link, the website provides a line of text that you can use as a credit when you use the image.



Choosing a graphics download site

Make sure you use a site you can trust when you search for Creative Commons files. Data files you download from the internet can contain malware. If you are unsure about a site, ask an adult for advice before you download any files.

Activity

Search for an image of a tiger using Wikimedia Commons or another site that your teacher recommends. Download an image and add it to a word-processor document. Insert the credit provided by the website below the image.

Extra challenge

Search the web to find out what the legal penalties are for software piracy. Penalties vary in different countries. You may need to add the name of your country in your search string.

Test

1. Name two types of intellectual property.
2. What information should you use in a credit when you use someone else's work?
3. Explain why intellectual property theft and software piracy are bad for the owners of content.
4. Explain why it is a good idea to use a Creative Commons site when you are searching for images to use in your work.

2.6 Giving credit

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to give credit when you use another person's work
- how to write a citation.

Using citations

How to credit an image

In the last lesson you learned how to find Creative Commons images on the web. Creative Commons images are shared by the people who made them. You can use most Creative Commons material free of charge, but you must give credit to the owner of the content. The text that you use to give credit is called a **citation** or an **attribution**.

In the lesson you downloaded an image from the Wikimedia Commons site. You learned how the site provides a citation for you to use with your downloaded image.

A Creative Commons citation includes the owner's name and a link to the image on the Wikimedia website. It looks like this:

> By Winfried Bruenken (Amrum) – Own work, CC BY-SA 2.5, https://commons.wikimedia.org/w/index.php?curid=1585973

Writing your own citation

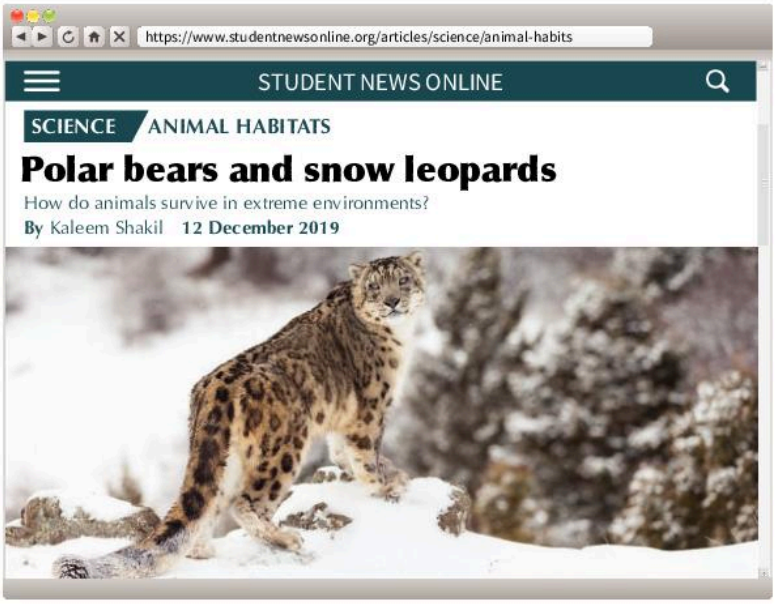
Sometimes the owner of a piece of work does not provide a citation for you to use. In that case, you need to write your own citation. There are four pieces of information you should include in a citation:

- **author:** the name of the person who created the work
- **year:** when the work was produced
- **title:** for example, the title of an article you are quoting from or the title of a picture you want to use
- **internet address:** the address of the site you are taking the work from. If the work you are using does not come from the internet, use the title of the book or newspaper where you found the work.



Can you find the four pieces of information you need for a citation in the news article at the top of the next page? Write a citation for this article.

There are times when you won't find some of the information you need. Don't worry. Just use what you can find.

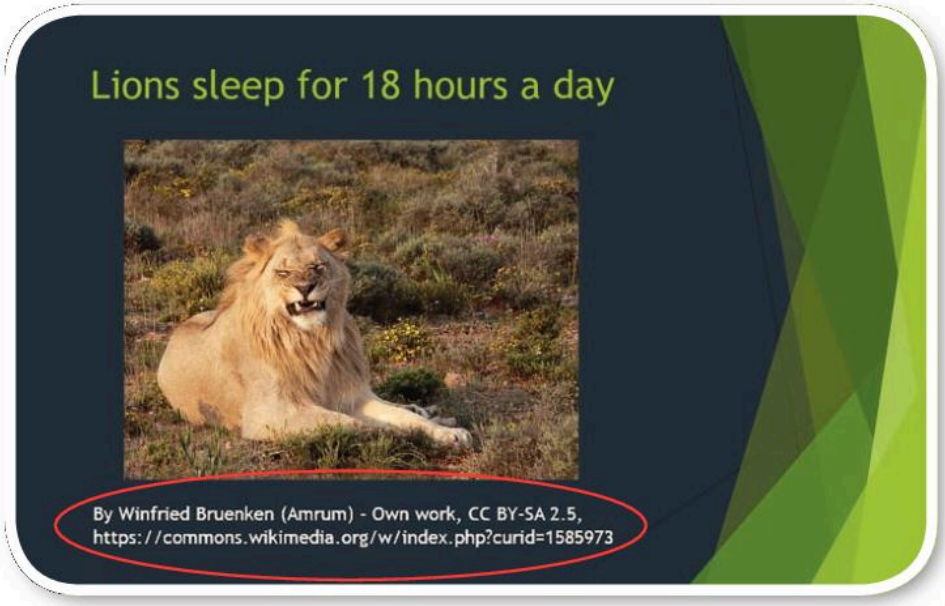


How to use a citation in your work

You should add a citation for every piece of content you use that is not your own work. Adding a citation is straightforward:

- Type or paste the citation immediately below the image or quoted text.
- Use a font that is a little smaller than the main text in your document. For example, if the text in your document is 12 points, use 10 points for your citation.

Here is an example of a citation in a presentation slide:



You can use the same method of adding a citation with other types of content. For example, you might use a video or a quote from a newspaper article. You might find a graph or a table that you want to use in your work. In every case, add a citation below the content.



Answer to the activity on page 54

A citation for the article shown at the top of page 55 will look like this:

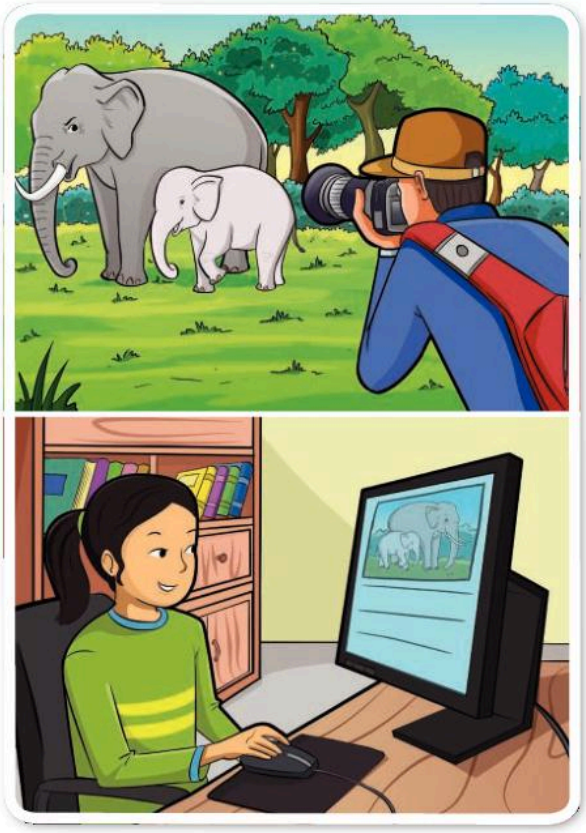
Kaleem Shakil, 2019, Polar bears and snow leopards, www.studentnewsonline.org

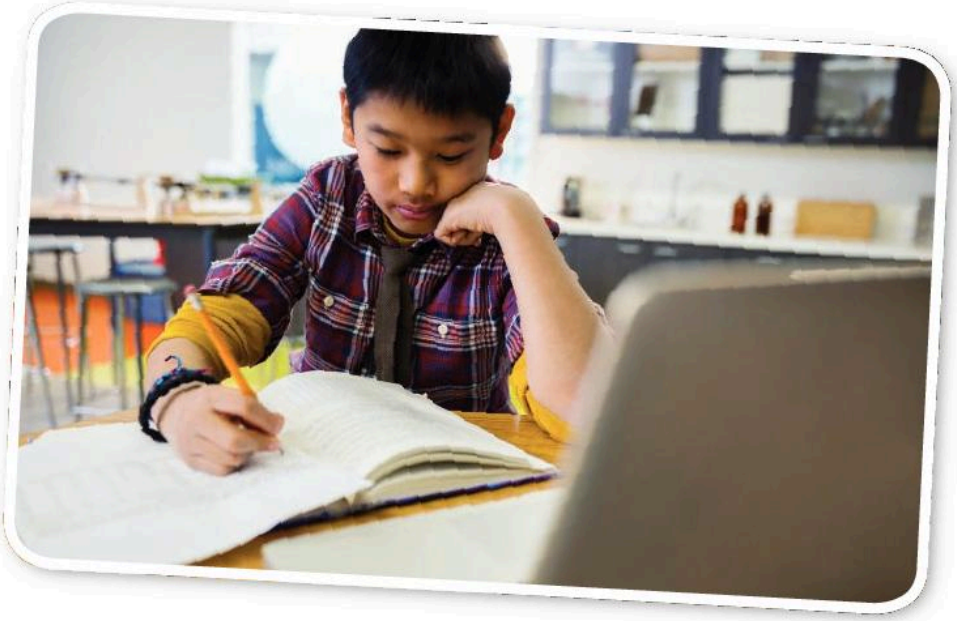
The citation includes the author's name, the year the article was written, the title of the article and the web address. Did you find all the information on the web page? If not, look at the image again to find the four parts of the citation.

Why are citations important?

There are four reasons why it is important to use citations to credit other people's work.

- You are giving credit to the person who created the content. Dishonest behaviour on the internet often involves someone losing money, for example by stealing someone's identity or their intellectual property. But people who create content are not just concerned with making money. People work hard to create new content and they are proud of it. They want to get credit for producing it.
- People use the internet to find information. They use web links from one document to another to find new facts. Someone who reads your work can follow the link in your citation to learn more about a subject.
- Citations make it clear what work is yours and what belongs to someone else. There is nothing wrong with using other people's knowledge in your own work. It is an important part of learning. But you must not pretend that someone else's work is your own. That is called **plagiarism**. If you use citations correctly, nobody can accuse you of plagiarism.
- Citations show your teacher that you have carried out research to complete your school assignments.





Digital citizen of the future



The internet can be dangerous. You can make it safer for yourself and others by doing the right things when you are online.

As a digital citizen of the future, remember to be cautious and to question everything you see and read on the internet. Keep your internet skills and knowledge up to date. Share your knowledge, and support friends and family who are learning how to use the internet.

Use the internet well and you will enjoy its benefits as you learn, work and lead your everyday life. Creating e-learning materials is a job that combines creative work with computing skills. Is it a career you would consider in the future?

Activity

Use word-processing or presentation software to create a short text about one of your hobbies or interests.

Write a paragraph about why you like this hobby or interest.

Find a relevant Creative Commons image to illustrate your text.

Search the web to find an interesting fact or quotation about your hobby or interest.

Add citations for the image and the quotation or interesting fact.

Extra challenge

When you download images and videos from the web, you must be confident that the site you are downloading from is safe and that the content will be free from malware. In the last lesson, two alternative sites to Wikimedia Commons were mentioned: Pixabay and Unsplash. Choose one of these and search the web for reviews of your chosen site.

Test

1 Why is it a good idea to search for images on a Creative Commons website?
2 What must you do if you want to use another person's content in an assignment?
3 What is plagiarism?
4 How can using citations improve your work?